

CHESTER AND DISTRICT TENNIS LEAGUE

STRUCTURE & RULES

2026 season

1. The League shall be known as the Chester and District Tennis League (CADSTL) and administered by a Committee consisting of a Chairperson, Secretary, Treasurer and a League Organiser for each Section. Three to form a quorum.
2. The League shall be open to teams in the district, subject to acceptance by the Committee.
3. The League shall have four Sections, Men's Womens, Mixed and Men's Veterans.
 - a. The Men's Veterans Section will be for players aged 55 in the season calendar year, or older.
4. The Committee has the discretion to split the Sections into appropriate Divisions depending upon the number of teams entered in a particular season.
5. Teams can only drop into lower leagues through relegation, not as a result of losing players. If a club with more than one team in a section withdraws a team, it must withdraw the lowest placed team.

Teams & Players

6. Each team shall consist of four players:
Men's Divisions - 4 men players
Mixed Divisions - 2 women and 2 men
Womens Divisions - 4 women players
7. All players must be bona-fide club members, and no players shall play for more than one Club in any one of the Sections per season.
8. All players must be registered on the online system before, or within 24 hours of, a match being played. Any rubbers played by an unregistered player will be awarded to the opposition team 6-0, 6-0.
9. All Players selected must play in order of merit.
10. For Clubs with more than one team in any of the Sections, any player having played on three occasions for any higher team, may not play subsequently for a lower team.

Match Scheduling, Format and Scoring

11. A match shall consist of four doubles rubbers, and each rubber is the best of three sets. A mixed match now consists of four mixed rubbers.
12. A 7 point tie-break (i.e. *the team who first wins 7 points shall win the tie-break, provided there is a margin of 2 points*) will come into operation at 6 games all in the 1st and 2nd sets.
13. If the score is one set all after the first two sets, a 10 point tie-break is the deciding final set. The first to get to 10 points is the winner, provided there is a margin of 2 points. To enter this on the online system, please record as a 1-0, or 0-1, as applicable.
14. One point will be awarded for every set won (including the 3rd tie-break set).
15. Should teams finish level on points/sets at the end of the season, placings will be decided on the basis of sets difference, and if still level, on games difference (3rd set tie-breaks count as one game). If the games difference is the same, then league placings will be based on the head-to-head results between the teams.
16. Matches must be played on the date stated in the fixture list.
17. In the case of inclement weather, the captains may agree to postpone the match.
 - a. In this event, games should be rearranged as soon as possible
 - b. The home Captain must offer three alternative dates (excluding dates where the away team has another CADSTL fixture) and inform the League organiser of the agreed date
 - c. If the postponement is in the first half of the season, the match must be played before the reverse fixture in the second half of the season
 - d. Failure to agree should be referred to the League Organiser
18. Non-Weather Defaults
 - a. Any team unable to fulfil a fixture will forfeit the match, with the score being recorded as all sets 6-0 to the non-defaulting team
 - b. The non defaulting captain should enter the result on the on-line system and must inform the League organiser within 48 hours, including the reason for default.
 - c. The defaulting team will have 8 points deducted in addition to the loss of match

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19. Exceptional circumstances
 - a. The defaulting Captain must notify the League organiser promptly to seek dispensation in exceptional circumstances; rescheduling requires agreement from the non-defaulting team who should be copied into any correspondence
 - b. If agreed, the home Captain must offer three alternative dates (excluding dates where the away team has another CADSTL fixture) and inform the League organiser of the agreed date as soon as confirmed
 - c. Rearranged matches must be played as soon as possible
 - d. If the postponement is in the first half of the season the match must be played before the reverse fixture in the second half of the season
20. For evening matches play will continue, where necessary, for up to 30 minutes after sunset unless all four players are in agreement to continue after this time.
21. Two rubbers must be completed otherwise the match must be replayed on a date agreed by both teams.
 - a. If after two completed rubbers a match is abandoned due to inclement weather, the remaining two rubbers will be halved. Games recorded in the online system as 6-0, 0-6 for each rubber
 - b. If a set is completed, then that set's game score should be recorded. The remaining set will be halved with 0.5 points awarded to each team
 - c. Games in sets that are not completed should not be recorded
22. The home captain should enter the result in the online system as soon as possible but within 1 week of the completion of the match.
 - a. It is the away team captain's responsibility to check if the results have been entered correctly and discuss with the home captain or notify the League Organiser as appropriate
 - b. Teams that regularly fail to enter their results shall be liable to loss of all points available, at the discretion of the Committee
23. Timings
 - a. Evening matches should commence at 6:15 p.m.
 - b. Weekend matches to commence at the starting time stated in the fixture list issued at the beginning of each season
 - c. No matches on a Saturday evening.
 - d. Any players not arriving within 30 minutes of the start time shall forfeit their first rubber. For the non-arrival of a player within a further 30 minutes, the offending team shall forfeit both rubbers
 - e. Veteran's matches will commence on a Monday to Friday between 10am and 2pm on a day selected by the home club
24. Floodlights
 - a. For evening matches floodlights are permitted if the away team agrees to the use of them. Such agreement should be sought before the match commences
 - b. Some clubs have time restrictions on floodlight use. The home captain must inform the away team of any restrictions before the match commences
25. The home club will provide a minimum of three new L.T.A. approved balls per first round rubber and have some reasonable spare balls available.
26. Courts should be clearly marked with white lines, and the only permanent lines on court should be for tennis.
27. If any team does not fulfil 75% of their matches by the end of August, all points from their fixtures will be void and the team relegated.
28. Teas are not required from the home club (unless agreed in advance by both Captains), though normal hospitality from the home club is expected

Administration

29. The affiliation fee, at the rate agreed by the Annual General Meeting, is to be paid by the 31st January for the following season.
30. The Committee shall be the absolute and sole authority for the interpretation of these rules, and their decision shall be final and binding on all clubs.

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31. An Annual General Meeting of the League will be held before the end of November each year at a date to be fixed by the Committee.
32. The Annual General Meeting shall:
 - a. Receive reports for the year and adopt accounts
 - b. Elect officers
 - c. Agree subscriptions for the ensuing season
 - d. Present Trophies to the League Winners
 - e. Consider any notices of motion (such notices of motion must be made in writing and received by the League Secretary by the 1st September)
33. A quorum for any General Meeting shall be representative of at least 50% of the member clubs.
 - a. Each club represented is entitled to one vote
 - b. A majority vote is if the number of positive votes exceeds the number of negative votes
 - c. If a tie the Chairperson is entitled to a casting vote
34. Registrations and applications by new teams must be received in writing by 31st January for the following season.
35. Any dispute arising on any matter connected with the League shall be reported to the Secretary in writing. The Committee shall consider such disputes and their decision is final.

Updated January 2026